

Spanish A1 — Final Performance Guide

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 12

Overview

Component	Format	Length	When
Part A — Spoken role play	Live conversation with instructor or partner	5–7 minutes	Session 24
Part B — Written message	Short text produced independently	8–10 sentences	Session 24 (in-session or take-home)

Students may refer to their Week 12 phrase bank during Part B. They may not read from a prepared script during Part A — a brief glance at the phrase bank is acceptable.

Part A — Spoken Role Play (5–7 minutes)

Scenario

Student meets someone (the instructor plays the role of a Spanish-speaking stranger) in a social or informal setting. The conversation moves through at least three of the four topic areas below.

Four topic areas (student must cover at least three):

1. **Introduction** — name, origin, profession, personal information (*ser* for identity; *estar* for states/location)
2. **Plans** — propose something to do together; suggest a time and place (*ir a + infinitivo*)
3. **Directions** — help the other person get somewhere in the city
4. **Description** — describe your home, your neighbourhood, or a place you like (*hay / está / están*)

Required Language

The following structures must appear somewhere in the role play:

- ☐ *Ser* used correctly at least once (identity, origin, or profession)
- ☐ *Estar* used correctly at least once (state, emotion, or location)
- ☐ *Ir a + infinitivo* for at least one near-future plan
- ☐ At least one question (using any question word: *qué, dónde, cómo, cuándo, cuánto*)
- ☐ At least one obligation or ability structure (*tener que, hay que, or poder*)

Students should not try to work through a checklist during the conversation — they should speak naturally. These structures will appear if students speak freely about familiar topics.

Scenario Options

The instructor may choose one of the following starting points:

Option A (default): You meet at a café, a language event, or a community activity. You get talking and discover a shared interest. You agree to meet again and give each other directions to the meeting point.

Option B: You are helping a Spanish-speaking visitor who is new to your city. They ask for directions, then you get talking about your lives.

Option C: You meet at a language exchange event. You both describe yourselves and their lives (*ser/estar*), and make a plan (*ir a + infinitivo*) to meet for coffee.

In all options, the conversation should feel natural — not a performed script.

Student Instructions (Part A)

- Use your own real life: your job, your neighbourhood, your real plans. This is easier than inventing.
- When you don't know a word, use a repair phrase: "*¿Cómo se dice...?*" or "*Estoy buscando la palabra para...*"
- If you lose track: "*¿Puede repetir?*"
- Getting stuck briefly is normal and not penalized — recovering gracefully is a skill.
- Do not memorize a script. Practice the topics; improvise the words.

Part B — Written Message (8–10 sentences)

Task

Write a short message to a new Spanish-speaking contact — someone you have just met online or at a language event. They have asked you to introduce yourself.

Your message must include:

- ☐ An introduction: who you are, where you are from, what you do (use *ser*)
- ☐ How you are feeling or something about your current situation (use *estar*)
- ☐ A description of your daily routine (at least 2 sentences)
- ☐ Something you enjoy doing (use *gustar*, *encantar*, or *preferir*)
- ☐ A suggestion to meet or do something together (*ir a + infinitivo* or *quisiera*)
- ☐ At least one question for the other person

Length: 8–10 sentences. Eight clear, correct sentences are better than twelve muddled ones.

Example opening (student must write their own — not copy this):

¡Hola! Me llamo Carlos, tengo 32 años y soy de Buenos Aires, aunque ahora vivo en Madrid desde hace cuatro años. Soy diseñador gráfico y trabajo en una empresa pequeña en el centro. Estoy muy contento aquí — me gusta mucho la ciudad. Por las mañanas me levanto temprano y desayuno antes de ir al trabajo. Los fines de semana me gusta jugar al tenis y a veces hago senderismo con amigos. ¿Qué haces tú en tu tiempo libre? Si quieres, podemos quedar para tomar un café la próxima semana. ¿Estás libre el sábado?

Student Instructions (Part B)

- Write about your own real life.
 - You may use the phrase bank for vocabulary and sentence starters.
 - Aim for variety: *ser* sentences, *estar* sentences, routine sentences, *gustar* sentences, a plan.
 - Check: *ser* vs. *estar* (is this describing identity or state?); article contractions (*al / del*); *gustar* agreement (*me gusta / me gustan*).
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A1 Readiness Indicators

A student has demonstrated solid A1 competency when they can:

- ☐ Introduce themselves in 4–5 sentences using *ser* and *estar* correctly
 - ☐ Ask and answer basic questions about daily life, work, and interests
 - ☐ Navigate at least 2 transactional scenarios (café, directions, shopping, pharmacy) with some hesitation
 - ☐ Describe their routine, home, or neighbourhood in 4–6 sentences
 - ☐ Use *ir a + infinitivo* for future plans
 - ☐ Use at least one obligation or ability structure (*tener que, hay que, poder*)
 - ☐ Use *gustar/doler* correctly (with *gusta/gustan* and *duele/duelen*)
 - ☐ Write a coherent personal message of 8+ sentences
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A2 Readiness Indicators

A student is approaching A2 readiness when they can also:

- ☐ Sustain a 7-minute conversation without long pauses
- ☐ Describe past events using pretérito (*fui, comí, vi...*)
- ☐ Use multiple modals in the same exchange
- ☐ Ask for clarification and rephrase when not understood
- ☐ Write 10+ sentences with consistent grammar and varied vocabulary

The A2 course will focus on: pretérito indefinido (regular + major irregulars), imperfecto, the contrast between them, futuro simple, comparatives/superlatives, and object pronouns.

A Note About Mistakes

Every student who completes the Spanish A1 final performance has done something genuinely difficult. Spanish presents unique challenges that English speakers do not face in other languages: choosing between *ser* and *estar* every single time you want to say "is" or "are"; the *gustar/doler* structure where the thing is the subject, not the person; reflexive verbs; stem-changing verbs. Students who have navigated all of this deserve to feel proud.

Mistakes at A1 are normal and expected. A student who tries to use *ir a + infinitivo* and makes a small error is doing something more impressive than one who only uses the safe patterns they memorized.

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